PAW & FOUND



Vet Visit Prep Kit

What to Ask, Bring & Track

Be prepared for every vet visit

Questions • Symptom tracker • Medication log • Visit records

📋 Before the Visit: 3-Day Prep

🗓️ 3 Days Before

- [ ] **Write down your concerns** — any behavior changes, symptoms, questions. Don't rely on memory.
- [ ] **Check medication supply** — note what needs refills. Bring current med bottles.
- [ ] **Gather documents** — vaccine history, previous lab results, adoption papers if it's a first visit.

📦 Day Before

- [ ] **Prepare the carrier/crate** — leave it open in a cozy spot with treats inside. Cats: spray Feliway 30 min before.
- [ ] **Collect a sample if needed** — urine or stool sample as requested. Refrigerate if not fresh.
- [ ] **Pack the vet bag** — see packing list on page 3. Keep it by the door.

🚗 Day Of

- [ ] **Light meal only** — don't feed a full meal right before (car sickness). Water is fine.
- [ ] **Potty break before leaving** — and again in the clinic parking lot before going in.
- [ ] **Bring this kit!** — You'll have your questions, symptom notes, and visit log ready.

🎒 What to Bring

- [ ] **Carrier, crate, or secure leash/harness** — even calm pets can bolt in a clinic. Cats MUST be in carriers.
- [ ] **This Prep Kit** — with your written questions, symptom notes, and blank visit log.
- [ ] **Vaccination records & medical history** — especially for first visits or new clinics.
- [ ] **Current medications** — bring the actual bottles, not just a list. Vet needs to see labels.
- [ ] **Stool or urine sample** — if requested. In a sealed container or bag, labeled with date and time.
- [ ] **High-value treats** — small, soft treats for rewarding calm behavior and distracting during exams.
- [ ] **Favorite small toy or blanket** — familiar scent reduces anxiety. A worn t-shirt of yours works too.
- [ ] **Paper towels & wet wipes** — for messes, drool, or muddy paws.
- [ ] **Payment method & insurance card** — know your pet insurance policy and what's covered.
- [ ] **A notebook or your phone** — to write down the vet's answers and follow-up instructions.

❓ Questions to Ask Your Vet

🍽️ Diet & Weight

- ☐ Is my pet at a healthy weight? What's their ideal range?
- ☐ Am I feeding the right amount? Right brand?
- ☐ Should I change their diet as they age?
- ☐ Any supplements you recommend?
- ☐ _____

🧠 Behavior Changes

- ☐ Is [specific behavior] normal for their age/breed?
- ☐ Could this be pain-related or medical?
- ☐ Should we see a behaviorist?
- ☐ _____

🛡️ Preventive Care

- ☐ Which vaccines are due or upcoming?
- ☐ Flea/tick/heartworm prevention — is my current plan effective?
- ☐ Dental health — do they need a cleaning?
- ☐ When should we do bloodwork?

❓ Questions (continued)

👴 Senior Pet Concerns (7+ years)

- ☐ Should we do senior bloodwork or urinalysis?
- ☐ Any signs of arthritis or joint pain I should watch for?
- ☐ Changes in hearing, vision, or cognitive function?
- ☐ Should we adjust exercise or diet for their age?

🤒 Specific Symptoms

Use the symptom tracker on page 6 to detail what you've noticed:

- ☐ What could be causing [specific symptom]?
- ☐ What tests would help diagnose this?
- ☐ What are our treatment options? (Ask about costs & side effects)
- ☐ When should I expect improvement? What's the follow-up plan?
- ☐ What signs mean I should call or come back sooner?

💰 Practical Questions

- ☐ Can you give me a cost estimate before treatment?
- ☐ Are there payment plans or financing options?
- ☐ Is there a less expensive alternative that's still effective?
- ☐ What's truly urgent vs. what can wait?

📊 Symptom Tracker

Use this before your vet visit to track what you've observed. Be specific — it helps the vet diagnose faster.

SYMPTOM	WHEN NOTICED	FREQUENCY	SEVERITY (1-5)	NOTES / TRIGGERS

Symptom categories: Vomiting • Diarrhea • Coughing • Limping • Scratching • Lethargy • Appetite changes • Drinking more/less • Urination changes • Behavior changes • Lumps/bumps • Bad breath • Weight changes

💉 Vaccination Schedule Reference

VACCINE	PUPPY/KITTEN SERIES	ADULT BOOSTER	LAST GIVEN	NEXT DUE
Rabies	12-16 wks	Every 1-3 yrs		
DHPP (Distemper)	6-8, 10-12, 14-16 wks	Every 1-3 yrs		
Bordetella	6-8 wks (may repeat)	Every 6-12 mos		
Leptospirosis	12, 16 wks	Annual		
Lyme	12, 16 wks	Annual		
Canine Influenza	6-8, 10-12 wks	Annual		
FVRCP (cats)	6-8, 10-12, 14-16 wks	Every 1-3 yrs		
FeLV (cats)	8-12, 12-16 wks	Annual		

💊 Current Medication Log

MEDICATION	DOSAGE	FREQUENCY	PRESCRIBING VET	REFILL?

💡 **Tip:** Bring the actual medication bottles to your vet visit. The label contains information your vet needs: dosage, prescribing vet, date, and pharmacy. Take a photo of each label for your records.

📝 Vet Visit Notes

Date: _____ **Vet:** _____

Clinic: _____ **Weight:** _____

Reason for Visit:

Vet's Findings / Diagnosis:

Treatment / Medications Prescribed:

Follow-Up Instructions:

Next Visit: _____ **Cost:** $_____

✅ Post-Visit Action Items

- [ ] **Fill prescriptions immediately** — don't wait. Set phone reminders for medication times.
- [ ] **Schedule follow-up** — book it now before you leave or right after you get home.
- [ ] **Update your records** — log the visit in this kit. File test results and invoices.
- [ ] **Monitor your pet** — note any changes after new meds or treatments. Call the vet if concerned.
- [ ] **Update pet insurance** — submit claims promptly. Keep copies of everything.
- [ ] **Celebrate a good visit!** — Treats, praise, a walk. Make vet visits end on a positive note so your pet builds positive associations.

🏥 You're an amazing pet parent.

Being prepared is the best thing you can do for your pet's health.